

AI VISIBILITY READINESS CHECKLISTTM

The Business Owner's Guide to Showing Up in
AI Search, Recommendations & Answer Engines

25

CHECKLIST ITEMS

5 SECTIONS

SCORING GUIDE

10 MISTAKES

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WELCOME

AI Visibility — and Why Your Business Needs It Now

Something changed in the way customers find businesses. It happened quietly, and most business owners didn't notice until it was already affecting them.

More and more people are searching by asking. They type a question into ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google's AI Overview, or another AI-powered tool — and they get an answer. Not a list of ten links. An answer. A recommendation. A business name.

Here's what most business owners don't know: that recommendation isn't random. It isn't based on who pays for ads. It's based on what AI systems can find, understand, and trust about your business.

That's AI visibility — the degree to which AI-powered systems can find your business, understand what it does, and confidently recommend it to the people who are asking.

“AI doesn't recommend the loudest business. It recommends the clearest one.”

If AI can't find your business, or if it finds confusing or inconsistent information, it won't recommend you. It will recommend the competitor that gave it what it needed.

Businesses that rank well in AI search have built the signals AI systems look for: clear entity information, consistent online presence, authoritative content, structured data, and a website that communicates exactly what they do and who they serve.

This checklist gives you a way to assess where your business stands right now. It covers the five most important areas that determine your AI visibility — and helps you identify exactly where the gaps are.

Work through each item honestly. Score yourself. Then use the results to decide what to do next.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Read each item. Check the box if it fully applies to your business today — not if you plan to do it, or if it sort of applies. Each checked item = 4 points. Total your score at the end of each section and carry it to the Scoring Guide.

THE CHECKLIST

Rate Your AI Visibility Readiness

Each item is worth 4 points. Check only those that are fully and currently true for your business. Maximum score: 100.

SECTION 1 — ENTITY CLARITY

5 items · 20 pts

Entity clarity is the foundation of AI visibility. AI systems build understanding of your business from consistent, verifiable information. If that information is missing, contradictory, or vague, AI systems cannot confidently recommend you.

- ☐ **1** My business name is spelled and formatted consistently across my website, Google Business Profile, social media, and any other online listings.
- ☐ **2** My website clearly states what my business does, who it serves, and where it operates — visible within the first few seconds of landing on the page.
- ☐ **3** My contact information — including email, phone, and service area or location — is easy to find without scrolling or searching.
- ☐ **4** My business is listed consistently on Google Business Profile and any relevant directories for my industry or location.
- ☐ **5** My About page names the founder, owner, or the key person behind the business — with enough context for a reader to understand who they're working with.

Section Score:

____ / 20

SECTION 2 — WEBSITE FOUNDATION

5 items · 20 pts

Your website is where AI systems go to learn about your business. A weak website foundation — missing pages, vague content, or poor structure — makes it nearly impossible for AI to understand and recommend you, regardless of how good your work actually is.

- ☐ **6** I have dedicated, individual pages for each of my services or product categories — not everything combined on a single services page.
- ☐ **7** I have a clear, substantive About page that explains who I am, why I started this business, and what makes my approach different.

☐

8

I have a Contact page with at least one working, human-readable contact method — not just a form with no email or address visible.

☐

9

My website loads quickly and is fully functional on mobile devices.

☐

10

I have a FAQ section or page that answers the most common questions customers ask before making a purchase or booking.

Section Score:

____ / 20

SECTION 3 — AUTHORITY & TRUST

5 items · 20 pts

AI systems evaluate credibility. They look for the same signals that build human trust: real client experiences, demonstrated results, professional credentials, and third-party mentions. Without these signals, AI has no evidence that your business is a reliable recommendation.

☐

11

My website includes testimonials or reviews from real clients or customers — with names, context, or specific outcomes where possible.

☐

12

I have at least one case study, project story, or example on my website that shows a real business result or transformation.

☐

13

My credentials, training, certifications, relevant experience, or professional background are listed somewhere on my website.

☐

14

My website has a clear, professional appearance — no broken elements, outdated design, or content that signals neglect.

☐

15

Other websites, directories, publications, or platforms reference or mention my business in a way that can be found online.

Section Score:

____ / 20

SECTION 4 — CONTENT VISIBILITY

5 items · 20 pts

Content is how AI systems learn what your business knows and what it stands for. Businesses with strong content visibility have given AI systems something to reference, quote, and recommend. Businesses without content are invisible to these systems — even if they're excellent at what they do.

☐

16

I publish educational content — blog posts, articles, guides, or resources — related to my area of expertise on a regular or semi-regular basis.

- ☐ **17** My content answers the specific questions my ideal customers are asking — not just what I want to tell them about.
- ☐ **18** My service descriptions are detailed enough to clearly explain what customers get, what the process looks like, and who the service is right for.
- ☐ **19** I use plain, specific language throughout my website — not vague phrases like “we deliver excellence” or “solutions for your needs.”
- ☐ **20** My website content is organized clearly, with headings and sections that allow readers — and AI systems — to find what they need quickly.

Section Score:

____ / 20

SECTION 5 — AI DISCOVERABILITY

5 items · 20 pts

AI discoverability is about the technical and structural signals that help AI systems classify and recommend your business. These signals often operate in the background — but their absence is felt in the results.

- ☐ **21** My website uses clear, descriptive headings (H1, H2, H3) that summarize each section's content — not clever phrases that require context to understand.
- ☐ **22** I have FAQ content written in a natural question-and-answer format — with the actual question as the heading and a direct, complete answer below it.
- ☐ **23** My business description is consistent across my website, Google Business Profile, LinkedIn profile, and any social media accounts I use.
- ☐ **24** My website uses structured data or schema markup to help search engines and AI systems understand my business, my services, and my content.
- ☐ **25** I can describe what my business does, who it helps, and what makes it different — in two to three clear, specific sentences.

Section Score:

____ / 20

TOTAL SCORE (add all 5 sections):

____ / 100

SCORING GUIDE

What Your Score Means

Your score reflects how much of the groundwork AI systems need is currently in place. This isn't a judgment of how good your business is — it's a measure of how well AI systems can see it.

At Risk

0 – 24 Points

Your business is largely invisible to AI-powered search and recommendation systems right now. The foundational signals AI systems need — entity clarity, a structured website, authority indicators, and consistent information across platforms — are mostly missing or inconsistent.

This isn't unusual. Most small businesses haven't had a reason to think about this until recently. But it does mean that customers searching by AI are very unlikely to find or receive a recommendation for your business — regardless of how good your work is.

The opportunity here is significant. Starting from a low baseline means relatively straightforward changes can produce meaningful improvements. Priority: entity clarity, website structure, and consistent information.

Emerging

25 – 49 Points

You have some of the basic signals in place, but significant gaps remain. AI systems can find parts of your business — but the picture they see is incomplete, inconsistent in places, or missing the authority signals that move a business from 'findable' to 'recommendable.'

At this stage, you're competing for AI recommendations in a limited way. Customers who ask AI about your specific business name may find you. Customers who ask AI for a recommendation in your category are much less likely to.

Focus: completing the website foundation, building out authority signals, and ensuring consistency across all platforms where your business information appears.

Competitive

50 – 74 Points

You've built a solid foundation. AI systems can find your business, understand what you do at a basic level, and see evidence that you're a real, operating business. You're likely appearing in some AI-generated recommendations.

The gap between 'Competitive' and 'Strong' is usually depth. Your content may be there but not optimized. Your structured data may be partial. Your authority signals may exist but not be well-connected.

At this level, the work shifts from building the foundation to strengthening specific signals: more detailed FAQ content, schema markup, richer service descriptions, and consistent cross-platform entity information.

Strong

75 – 100 Points

Your business has built most of the signals AI systems need to find, understand, and recommend you. You're likely appearing in AI-generated recommendations with some regularity, and customers using AI search tools are more likely to encounter your business than most competitors.

A high score doesn't mean the work is done. AI systems change. New platforms emerge. Competitors improve their visibility over time. Strong AI visibility is maintained through ongoing content creation, regular audits, and attention to new signals as they become relevant.

At this level, the value is in optimization — refining what's already there, expanding into new content areas, and staying ahead of how AI systems are evolving in your category.

COMMON MISTAKES

10 Mistakes That Make Businesses Invisible to AI

Most AI visibility problems aren't the result of technical failures. They're the result of common patterns that made sense before AI search changed the game. Here are the ten mistakes that most consistently prevent AI systems from understanding or recommending a business.

01 Inconsistent Business Information Across Platforms

If your business name is "Smith & Co." on your website, "Smith and Company" on Google, and "Smith Co" on Yelp, AI systems see three different entities — not one business. Inconsistency signals uncertainty. Uncertainty leads to no recommendation. Every platform where your business appears should use the same name, address format, phone number, and description.

02 A Homepage That Explains Nothing Specific

"We help businesses grow." "Your success is our mission." These phrases tell AI systems nothing useful. AI needs to know specifically what you do, who you do it for, where you operate, and what distinguishes you from others. Vague language is invisible language. If a stranger couldn't describe your business from your homepage in one sentence, AI can't either.

03 No Service Pages — Just a Services Menu

A single page listing ten services with one sentence each gives AI very little to work with. Businesses that show up in AI recommendations typically have individual, detailed pages for each service — with full descriptions, who it's for, what the process looks like, and what outcomes to expect. Depth creates discoverability.

04 Missing or Thin About Page

AI systems weight founder and operator information heavily when evaluating a service business. An About page that says "We are a team of passionate professionals" does almost nothing. An About page that names the founder, explains their background, describes why they started the business, and establishes their credentials gives AI the entity signals it needs to confidently represent you.

05 No Contact Information Visible on the Website

AI systems use contact information as a credibility and location signal. If your email, phone, or service area isn't visible on your website — not buried in a form, but actually present as readable text — AI systems have less evidence that you're a real, operating business. This is one of the most common audit findings, and one of the easiest to fix.

06 No Educational Content

Businesses that publish content give AI systems something to reference and quote. Businesses that publish only promotional content have nothing AI can use to answer a customer's question. If AI can't use your content to help a user, it has no reason to send a user to you. Content that educates creates the conditions for recommendation.

07 FAQ Content That Isn't Actually in Q&A; Format

Many businesses have FAQ sections that look like FAQ sections but aren't structured as real questions and answers. Headings like "Our Process" or "Why Us" aren't questions — they're marketing headings. AI systems specifically look for content formatted as a real question followed by a direct, complete answer.

08 No Testimonials or Proof of Results

AI systems evaluate whether recommending a business is likely to result in a good experience. Testimonials, case studies, and demonstrated results are evidence that the recommendation is safe to make. Without them, you're asking AI to recommend you on faith. Real client feedback — even a small number of specific, genuine testimonials — signals that your business delivers on what it promises.

09 No Structured Data (Schema Markup)

Schema markup is code that tells AI systems and search engines exactly what kind of entity your website represents, what type of business you are, who runs it, what services you offer, and how to contact you. Without it, AI has to infer all of this from your content — and it sometimes gets it wrong. Schema is not optional for AI visibility. It's a core signal.

10 Treating AI Visibility Like SEO

SEO is about ranking in a list. AI visibility is about being the answer to a question. These are different systems with different requirements. Businesses that apply old SEO playbooks to AI search end up optimizing for the wrong signals. AI systems aren't looking for the most keywords. They're looking for the clearest, most credible, most complete picture of a business — which requires a different approach.

NEXT STEPS

What to Do With Your Score

Now that you have a score, the question is: what do you do with it?

The answer depends on where you scored — but there's a common thread: you can't improve what you haven't measured accurately. Most business owners who work through this checklist are surprised by the gaps. Once you can see them clearly, you can address them systematically.

0 – 24 — At Risk

- Start with entity clarity. Make your business name, description, and contact information consistent everywhere — website, Google, directories.
- Build or fix your About page. Name yourself. Explain your background. Give AI something real to work with.
- Add a Contact page with a visible email address and service area.
- Consider a professional AI Visibility Audit before investing further — so you know exactly what to prioritize.

25 – 49 — Emerging

- Complete your service pages. Each service should have its own page with a full, detailed description.
- Add testimonials. Even two or three specific, genuine client quotes build significant trust signals.
- Start publishing FAQ content in real Q&A; format — focused on the questions your clients actually ask.
- An AI Visibility Audit will identify which gaps are costing you the most visibility right now.

50 – 74 — Competitive

- Invest in structured data (schema markup). If you're not sure whether your site has it, assume it doesn't.
- Deepen your content. Each FAQ answer, each service description, each case study is a signal AI can use.
- Audit your cross-platform consistency. Even small inconsistencies in business information create friction.
- An AI Visibility Audit will show you specifically where your current ceiling is and what's holding you there.

75 – 100 — Strong

- Focus on content depth and freshness. AI systems favor businesses with current, relevant content.
- Expand into new content areas: longer guides, detailed how-tos, and educational resources.
- Monitor how AI platforms represent your business. ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews may describe you differently.
- An AI Visibility Audit provides a baseline that lets you track improvement over time.

ABOUT THE AI VISIBILITY OS™ AUDIT

This checklist gives you a self-assessment. The AI Visibility OS™ Audit gives you an accurate, professional analysis.

The audit is a comprehensive evaluation of your business's AI visibility across the platforms your customers are actually using — ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, and others. It examines how AI systems currently find, understand, and represent your business; documents what's missing, what's inconsistent, and what's working; and produces a written report with a prioritized gap analysis and specific, actionable recommendations.

Every engagement at Beth Aden AI is built on the Beth Aden AI Visibility Framework™ — a structured methodology developed through direct implementation experience. The audit is where that methodology begins.

Ready to See What AI Finds?

You've identified where your business stands. Now find out what AI systems actually see when they look for you — and exactly what to change to improve it.

The AI Visibility OS™ Audit is a comprehensive, professional evaluation of your business's current AI visibility — delivered as a written report with prioritized recommendations and a walkthrough session to go through the findings together.

Book Your AI Visibility Audit

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Beth reviews every inquiry personally and responds within 1–2 business days.

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